

ARTICLE 3: THOROUGHFARES

Information for the Special Town Meeting, September 14, 2026

WHAT THE ARTICLE DOES

It adds a new Article 3, “Thoroughfares,” to the Core Zoning Code, with standards for streets, roads, driveways, and entrances. It repeals the Road, Driveway, and Entrance Ordinance adopted in 2020, renumbers the later Articles of the Code, and makes related changes in Articles 2, 4, 8, and 9.

HOW ROADS ARE SORTED

The 2020 ordinance sorts roads by ownership. A public road needs a 20 ft paved travel way; a private road needs a 12 ft travel way that need not be paved; both need a 50 ft right-of-way. Driveways have no design standards, only entrance rules.

Article 3 sorts roads by the kind of place they run through, into ten Types: five Streets, from Main Street to Alley, and five Roads, from Connector Road to Rural Highway. Widths are set for each Type. Who owns a road is recorded separately.

DOES ANYTHING ABOUT MY ROAD OR DRIVEWAY HAVE TO CHANGE?

No. Adopting Article 3 does not require any existing road or driveway to be changed, widened, or rebuilt.

A driveway remains a driveway. A way that serves no more than two single-family homes, or one two-family home, is a driveway – whatever name or Type the Town’s list of roads shows for it.

A road’s Type applies only when:

- a new road is built;
- an existing road is substantially reconstructed – for example rebuilt below the surface, widened, extended, given sidewalks, or paved where it was gravel; or
- a driveway is expanded to serve more homes.

Ordinary maintenance, such as patching, resealing, or replacing a culvert, does not trigger the standards.

IF A DRIVEWAY IS EXPANDED TO SERVE MORE HOMES

Once it serves more than two homes, it is no longer a driveway and must meet the Type already listed for it:

- **Three or four homes:** the safety essentials only – travel-way width, drainage, sight lines and layout where it meets the road, and a turnaround on a dead end. No sidewalk or planting strip.
- **Five or more homes, a subdivision, or a road offered to the Town:** the full standard for its Type.

A way that already serves three or four homes when Article 3 takes effect may continue as it is.

THE LIST OF EVERY ROAD

Every road segment in town, 214 in all, is listed with its Type; 72 are recorded as driveways today, for reference. Because each Type is set in advance, no one needs a ruling on which standard applies. A Type can be changed only through the reclassification process in Article 3.

STREET TREES

Along Streets (Types S1–S5), healthy mature trees near the road are protected when the Town or a builder works in the right-of-way: the work must avoid their roots where it reasonably can, and a tree that has to come out must be replaced. Utility companies are asked to give notice and to work around roots where they can.

The full text, the list of every road, and the Type Map are in the Town Meeting edition of the Core Zoning Code.